Critical Capabilities for Enterprise Wired and Wireless LAN Infrastructure

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Initiatives:I&O Platforms

Wired and wireless LAN vendors evaluated in this research offer solid functionality for basic connectivity needs. As enterprises pursue a hands-off, autonomous operational environment, I&O leaders should focus investments on differentiated software capabilities like AI networking, automation, security and IoT containment.

This Critical Capabilities is related to other research:

Magic Quadrant for Enterprise Wired and Wireless LAN Infrastructure

View All Magic Quadrants and Critical Capabilities

Overview

Key Findings

- Several new vendors, including network as a service (NaaS) providers Join Digital, Meter and Nile, qualified for inclusion, with Meter and Nile delivering strong capabilities in the hands-off NetOps use case.
- While most vendors are making incremental enhancements, vendors like Juniper and Huawei are making significant leaps in AI networking capabilities, outpacing others in advanced network management.
- The proliferation of IoT and OT devices is driving adoption of the unified wired and wireless LAN use case. To support this, campus fabric segmentation and zero-trust LAN capabilities are required, which automate and secure corporate connectivity, making legacy implementations obsolete.

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Recommendations

Infrastructure and operations (I&O) leaders responsible for planning, sourcing and managing wired and wireless networks should:

- Document business requirements detailing users, devices, applications and locations, and align with one of the four use cases in this report before starting infrastructure upgrade/refresh projects.
- Conduct proofs of concept (PoCs) based on software capabilities for automation of network operations, secure onboarding, segmentation and adaptive access control for IT/IoT/OT devices.
- Prioritize investment in advanced LAN infrastructure network management, with capabilities such as AI-assisted troubleshooting, intent-based verification and tight IT service management (ITSM) integration.
- Focus on Day 0 design and Day 1 implementation at vendor selection stage. Focusing solely on Day 2 operational software may result in issues that are difficult to rectify or leave lingering problems for years.

Strategic Planning Assumptions

By 2028, 35% of enterprises will use artificial intelligence to improve network operations and resilience, which is a major increase from fewer than 10% in 2025.

By 2028, on-premises campus network as a service (NaaS) will be adopted by 15% of all enterprises, which is a significant increase from fewer than 2% in 2025.

By 2029, 20% of enterprises will replace network access control (NAC) and/or embedded switching security features with zero-trust network access (ZTNA) on corporate-owned campus LANs, compared with fewer than 2% in early 2025.

What You Need to Know

Wired and wireless LAN infrastructure offerings scored in this research provide foundational connectivity for basic connectivity needs. However, I&O leaders also require capabilities for AI networking, automation, campus fabric segmentation, security and guest services, for which there is more differentiation. Additionally, consumption-based NaaS offerings provide an alternative to traditional procurement and operational methods. This research assesses 16 offerings from 15 vendors across seven capabilities supporting four enterprise use cases.

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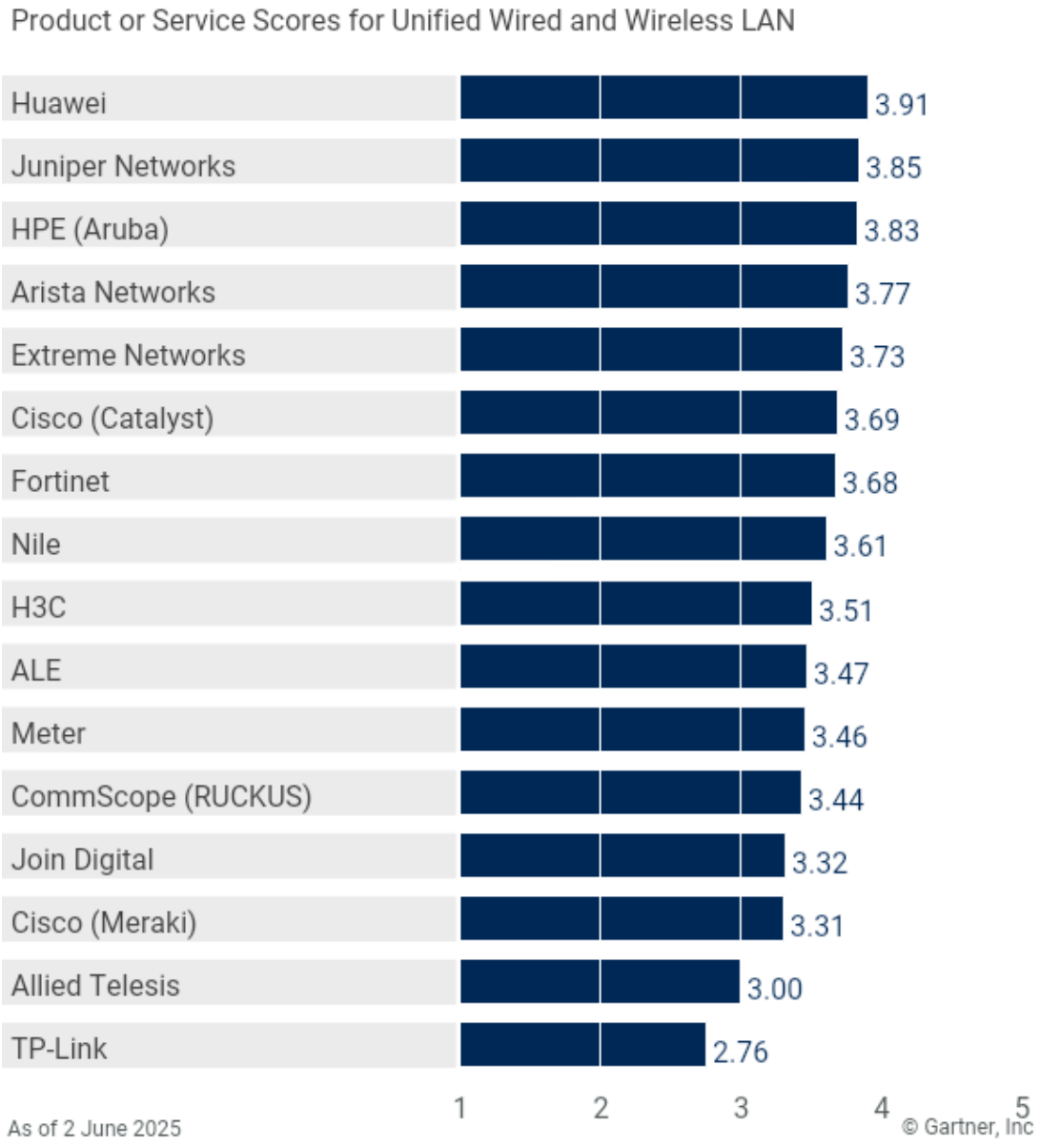
Analysis

Critical Capabilities Use-Case Graphics

Vendors' Product Scores for Unified Wired and Wireless LAN Use Case



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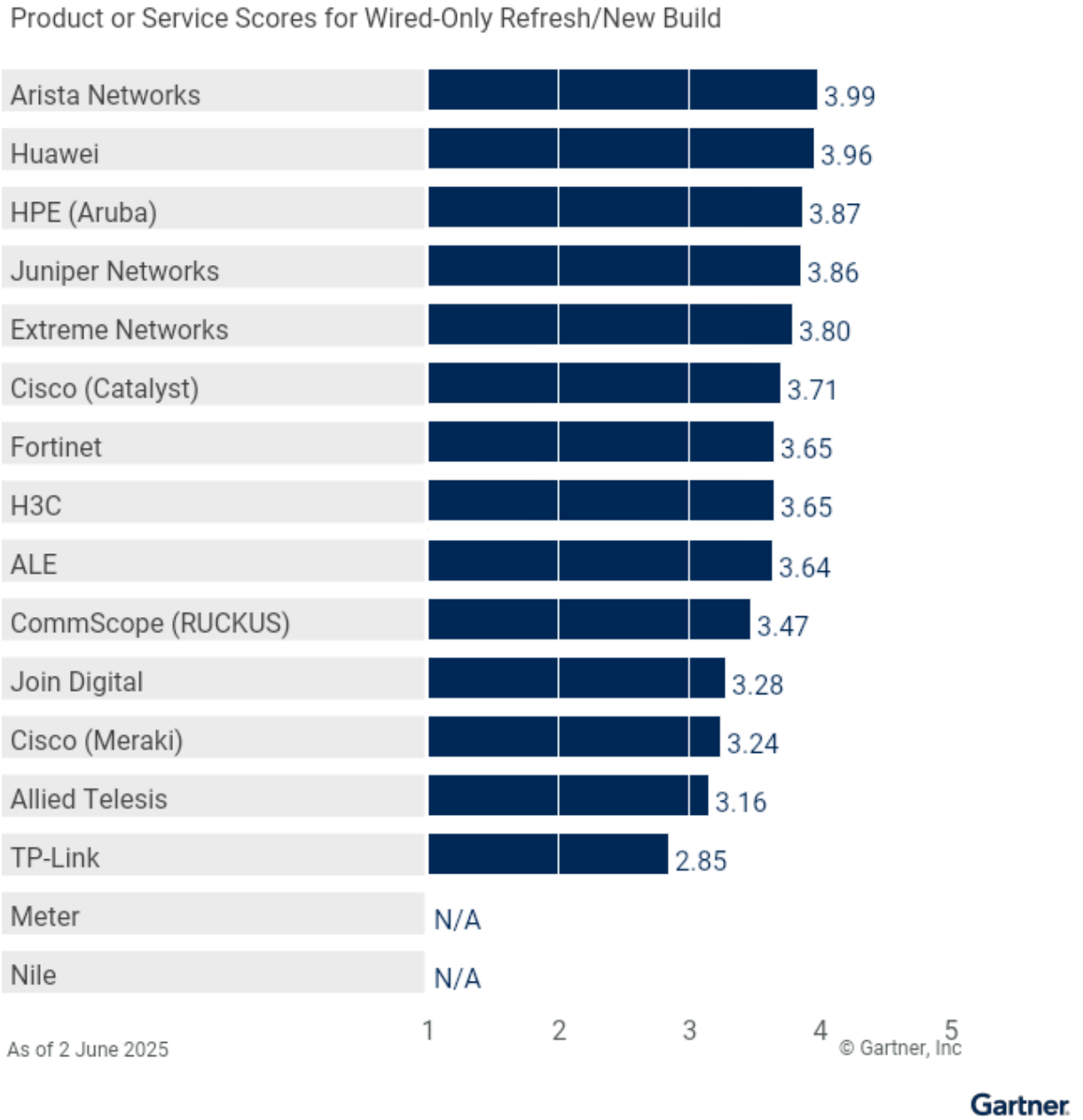
Vendors' Product Scores for Wired-Only Refresh/New Build Use Case



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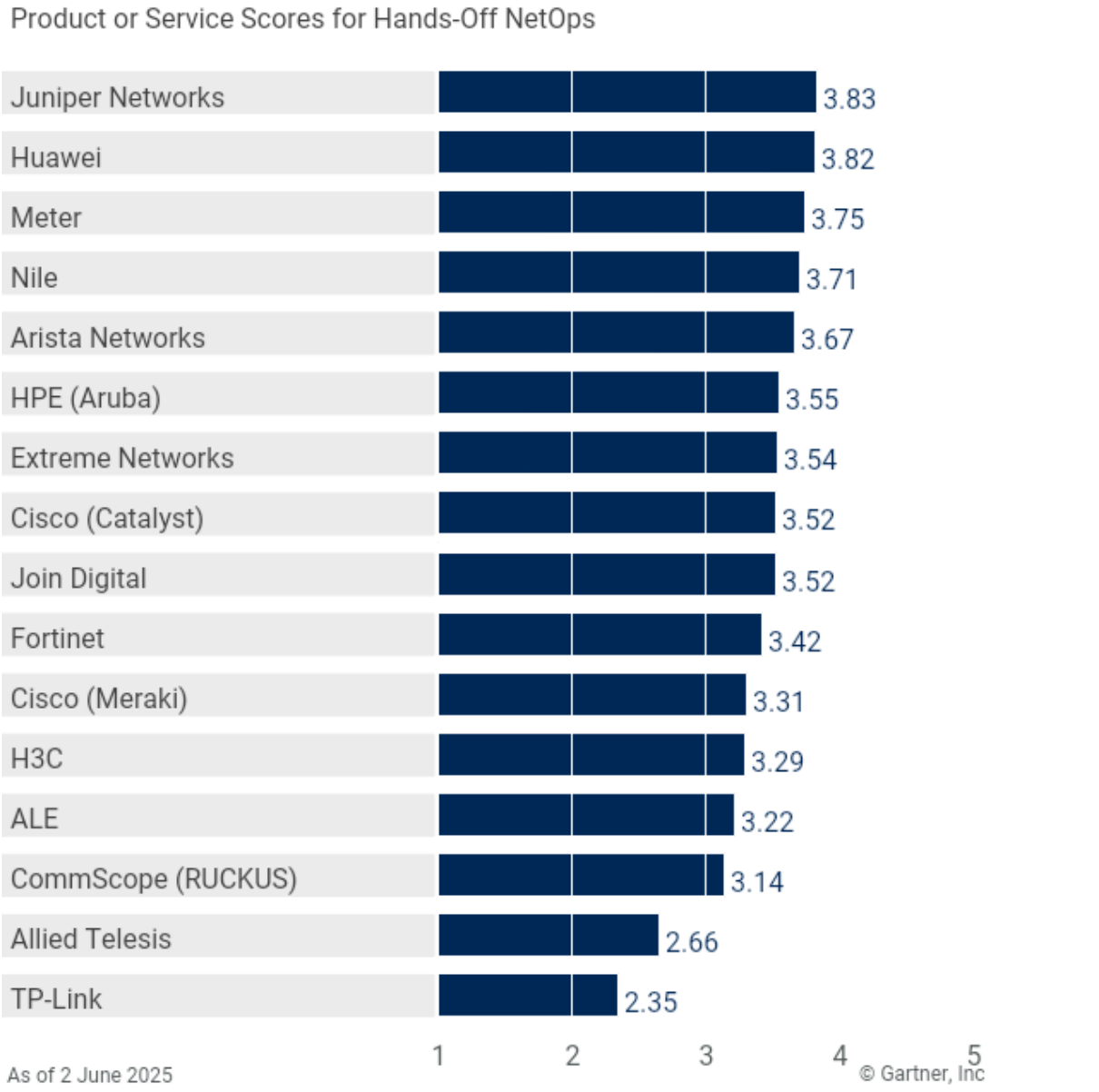
Vendors' Product Scores for Hands-Off NetOps Use Case



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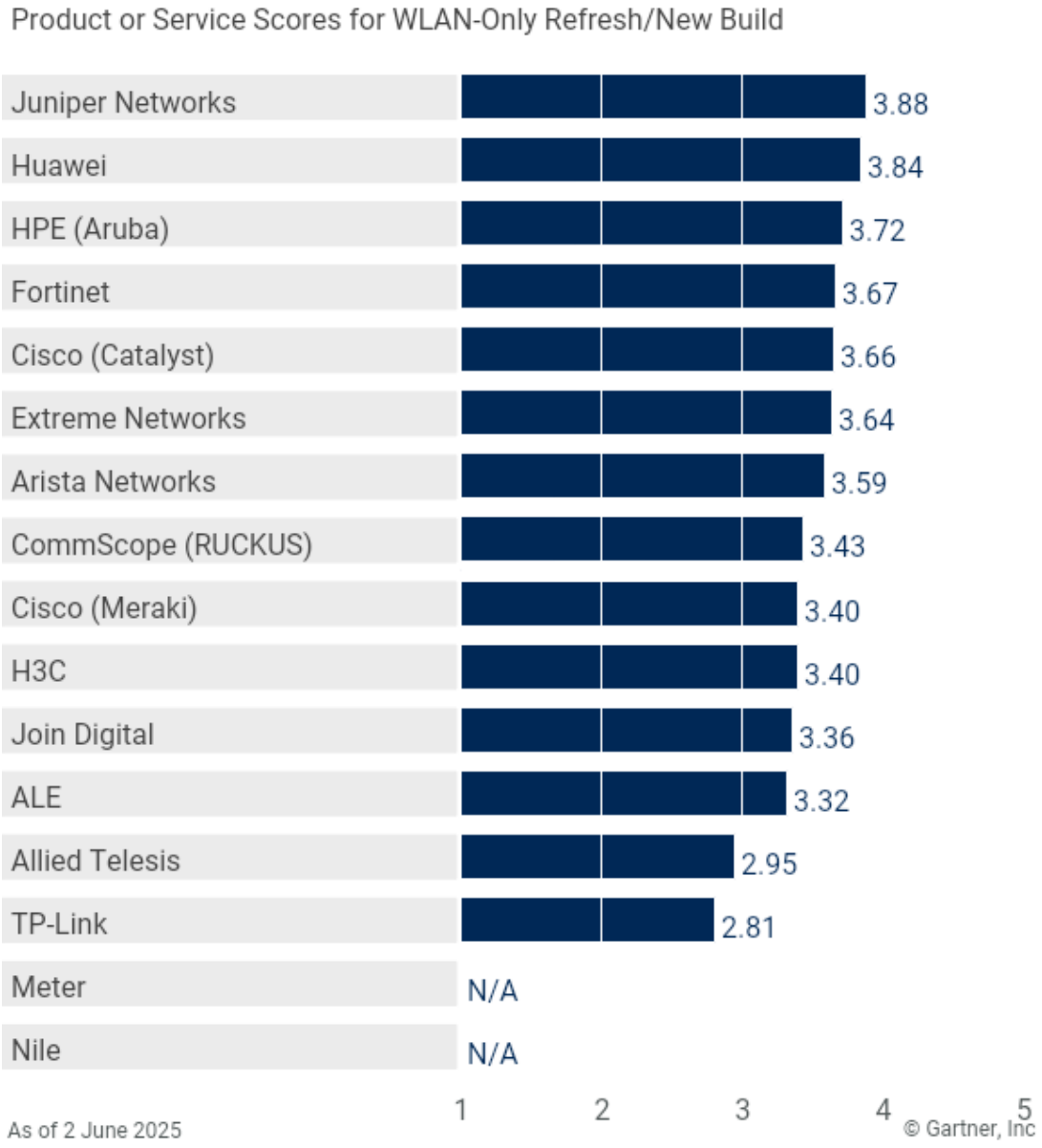
Vendors' Product Scores for WLAN-Only Refresh/New Build Use Case



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Vendors

ALE

Alcatel-Lucent Enterprise (ALE) has a broad portfolio of LAN products. Network management is offered as SaaS with OmniVista Cirrus, and on-premises with the OmniVista 2500 Network Management System. Recently introduced, ALE Fleet Supervision offers inventory management without added costs. ALE's fabric predominantly leverages Shortest Path Bridging (SPB) as the data plane technology, but also supports Ethernet VPN (EVPN) and Multiprotocol Label Switching (MPLS) under the same network operating system (NOS).

ALE's offering has strong campus fabric capabilities, allowing unified policy enforcement for users and IoT endpoints, managing network access based on identity, security posture, device type and application usage. Additionally, its offering provides strong guest services, supporting multiple onboarding and network access control (NAC) mechanisms that integrate with its fabric. However, ALE lags in AI networking capabilities, largely limited to radio resource management (RRM) features.

ALE's strongest use-case score is for the wired-only refresh/new build use case. This is due to its strong fabric technology and hardware, including modular chassis switches. ALE's weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to the limitations of its AI networking features.

Allied Telesis

Allied Telesis' offering primarily includes switches and access points that benefit from a unified operating system, AlliedWare Plus, which provides a single management and configuration capability across all products. Network management is delivered by three applications: Vista Manager; Autonomous Wave Control (AWC) wireless controller; and Autonomous Management Framework Plus (AMF Plus).

AMF Plus delivers device/network health monitoring, QoS traffic prioritization and troubleshooting of egress queue issues that cause packet loss. Additionally, AMF Plus provides central policy enforcement for a campus fabric supporting Virtual Extensible LAN (VXLAN). However, Allied Telesis has limited AI networking capabilities and lacks user entity behavior analytics (UEBA) and advanced zero-trust LAN security functionality.

Allied Telesis' strongest use-case score is for the wired-only refresh/new build use case, partly due to the breadth of its portfolio, which includes high-density modular chassis switches. Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to limitations in its AI networking capabilities that do not significantly reduce manual efforts.

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Arista Networks

Arista Networks' Cognitive Campus includes wireless access points and a broad selection of switches, with strong network security services leveraging NAC and network detection and response (NDR).

Arista's offering provides strong wired LAN capabilities through a unified operating system — Arista EOS. Arista Switch Aggregation Group (SWAG) enables a group of switches to provide stacking functionality, which allows management through a single IP address across various topologies like leaf-spine and traditional ring or chain, scaling up to 48 campus elements. In addition, Cognitive Campus provides wired and wireless campus fabric capability, including advanced network telemetry/state, ML/AI-driven operations and multifunction radios. While strong in some aspects of wireless LAN, such as intrusion prevention, Arista lags other evaluated solutions in guest networking capabilities.

Arista Networks achieved the highest use-case score in this research in the wired-only refresh/new build category, partly due to its VXLAN/EVPN-based virtual stacking offering SWAG. Its weakest use-case score is for WLAN-only refresh/new build, partly due its limitation in guest networking.

Cisco (Catalyst)

Cisco's Catalyst provides a broad wired and wireless LAN portfolio, which focuses on on-premises, campus-fabric-based deployments with Cisco's Software-Defined Access (SD-Access) and management from Cisco's Catalyst Center software (formerly known as DNA Center). The portfolio is primarily configured through an on-premises controller/appliance; however, the software can be installed in the cloud.

Catalyst has strong campus fabric capabilities. SD-Access provides campus fabric automation and enforces access policies based on context and identity by leveraging Cisco Identity Services Engine (ISE), the vendor's NAC offering. Additionally, the integration of ThousandEyes into Catalyst Center provides advanced digital experience monitoring, enhancing the ability to monitor and troubleshoot network issues effectively. However, Cisco lags other evaluated solutions in AI networking capabilities, such as virtual network assistants, which weakens its LAN infrastructure management capability.

Cisco Catalyst's strongest use-case score is for the wired-only refresh/new build use case. This is partly attributed to the breadth of hardware portfolio and functionality within IOS XE. Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to lagging AI networking capabilities.

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Cisco (Meraki)

Cisco's Meraki portfolio of wired and wireless LAN products is configured primarily through the cloud-based Meraki dashboard. As part of Cisco's strategy to deliver common hardware, recent selection of Wi-Fi 7 access points are Cisco wireless branded products. These access points generationally replace Meraki-branded MR access points. The Meraki cloud-based dashboard supports the MS switching and Catalyst 9300 products, with expansion for the Catalyst 9000 series portfolio in progress.

Meraki's capabilities for wireless include AI networking features that target WLAN radio resource management (RRM), as well as integration of ThousandEyes, which provides advanced digital experience monitoring, enhancing the ability to monitor and troubleshoot network issues effectively. Additionally, Meraki integrates with Cisco's ISE to deliver NAC onboarding and authentication services. Although Cisco has started offering a cloud-based NAC, ISE remains on-premises. This may create challenges for Meraki deployments striving for parity in a cloud-only environment.

Meraki's strongest use-case score is for the WLAN-only refresh/new build use case, partly due to its integration with ThousandEyes, which delivers increased administrator observability. Its weakest use-case score is for wired-only refresh/new build, partly due to a lack of modular chassis switches and limitations with campus fabric deployments.

CommScope (RUCKUS)

RUCKUS Networks, owned by CommScope, has a broad LAN portfolio, which includes RUCKUS One, its network management and AI platform, and the Cloudpath Enrollment System, a NAC offering.

RUCKUS' offering has robust wired and wireless LAN capabilities, which include advanced antenna designs, dynamic preshare key features for microsegmentation (including for IoT devices) and virtual distributed chassis technology. In addition, the RUCKUS One platform provides network assurance services and digital twin features. RUCKUS Edge extends these capabilities to the edge, to support low latency networking and security services. However, the AI networking features of RUCKUS One predominantly target RRM use cases and its digital twin capabilities are limited to Wi-Fi.

RUCKUS' strongest use-case score is for the wired-only refresh/new build use case, partly due to a campus fabric that supports granular policy enforcement and segmentation, capabilities that can be extended to the edge with RUCKUS WAN Gateway (RWG). Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, partly due to limitations in AI networking capabilities focused on wireless RF optimization.

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Extreme Networks

Extreme Networks has a broad wired/wireless LAN offering, which can be managed on-premises or from the cloud with ExtremeCloud IQ. A strong networking fabric offering provides virtualized network services that focus on performance and security.

Extreme Networks' Fabric Connect spans campus, data centers and branches, and uses autodiscovery and microsegmentation to simplify network operations, increase automation and reduce IT risk. In addition, ExtremeAnalytics provides insights into network and application performance, with extensive application identification capabilities for network monitoring and troubleshooting. However, Extreme Networks lacks a NaaS offering (based on Gartner's definition), and although ExtremeCloud IQ facilitates multivendor management, advanced AI networking functionalities are exclusive to Extreme Networks' infrastructure.

Extreme Networks' strongest use-case score is for the wired-only refresh/new build use case, due to the differentiation of its campus fabric and third-party management capabilities. Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to limitations with current delivered AI networking functionality, including lack of ITSM integration.

Fortinet

Fortinet's offering primarily focuses on security and tight integration between wired, wireless and security products through a single unified operating system, FortiOS. Fortinet continues to expand its OT capabilities by aligning with the Purdue model for industrial control systems (ICS), integrating IT and OT into a single platform, and allowing virtual security patching for IT and OT endpoints.

Fortinet's offering has strong security capabilities, including UEBA, universal ZTNA and NAC. FortiNAC addresses advanced NAC requirements and support of multivendor networks. Additionally, FortiMonitor provides digital experience monitoring for applications across the entire network, sharing telemetry data with FortiAIOps for proactive troubleshooting and trend analysis. However, Fortinet lacks a chassis-based switch, which limits its ability to address high-density access or high-speed core/distribution requirements.

Fortinet's strongest use-case score is for the unified wired and wireless LAN use case, based on strong zero-trust LAN and campus fabric segmentation capabilities. Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, partly due to limited AI networking integrations with ITSM.

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H3C

H3C has a broad wired/wireless LAN offering, which can be managed either on-premises or from the cloud. The Application-Driven Campus Network (AD-Campus) serves as the vendor's network management platform, featuring AI/ML-driven capabilities, while Cloudnet provides cloud-based network management.

H3C's campus network access protocol integration includes Ethernet Optical, Passive Ethernet Optical, EPON/XEPON and GPON/XGSPON. The offering provides centralized automation, network connectivity and policy orchestration across LAN, WLAN and WAN fabrics. Network and fabric wizards streamline configuration and provisioning. The policy manager enforces dynamic role-based policies, while AI-powered client insights and third-party NAC offerings enhance access control and segmentation. However, H3C's offering lacks third-party ITSM tool integration for AI networking, as well as a published SLA and NaaS offering.

H3C's strongest use-case score is for the wired-only refresh/new build use case, due in part to its robust infrastructure portfolio, which includes end-to-end optical network products. Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to its limited LAN infrastructure management and AI networking capabilities.

HPE (Aruba)

The Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) Aruba offering includes HPE Aruba Networking Central, NetConductor and NAC, which delivers a powerful fabric-based wired and wireless network. With Aruba's UEBA functionality enabled, the system can deliver a ZTNA implementation with ongoing monitoring and enforcement controls. HPE Aruba continues to invest in its cloud offering, which is integrated with HPE GreenLake.

HPE Aruba Networking provides strong security capabilities for zero-trust LAN, including NAC and UEBA. Additionally, it offers data collection capabilities with its time travel feature, which slices historical data (up to seven days) into granular insights for root cause analysis. However, while the integration of OpsRamp enables Central to manage third-party devices, its multivendor support is currently not on par with the legacy on-premises AirWave network management platform. Although AirWave is still supported for now, it will eventually be replaced by Central.

HPE Aruba's strongest use-case score is for the wired-only refresh/new build use case, due to strength in security and campus fabric. Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, where integration with third-party tools and automation capabilities received average scoring.

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HPE announced its intention to acquire Juniper Networks on 9 January 2024. At the time of this evaluation and publication, however, HPE and Juniper Networks operate as separate legal entities. Gartner will provide further insight as more details become available.

Huawei

Huawei's offering includes a strong wired and wireless LAN portfolio, featuring CloudEngine S-series switches and AirEngine wireless APs. The offering includes advanced AI networking, along with dynamic access and intent-based controls. Huawei CloudCampus is enabled by centralized network management through iMaster NCE that serves as the AI/ML enabled platform. Besides active Ethernet, Huawei also has passive and optical LAN offerings.

Huawei ships the broadest portfolio of Wi-Fi 7 APs, combined with AI-based application identification and VIP FastPass for prioritized user access. Additionally, it provides advanced security with campus fabric and zero-trust LAN capabilities, such as automated threat detection and blocking of lateral movements. However, Huawei lacks a NaaS offering (based on Gartner's definition) and many of the advanced capabilities of CloudCampus require iMaster NCE-Campus, which can be complex or costly for some organizations in on-premises deployment mode.

Huawei achieved the highest score in this research for the unified wired and wireless LAN use case due to its advanced AI networking, intent-based controls, zero-trust security, and management dashboard. Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, despite its score being among the highest in this report.

Join Digital

Join Digital's offering is primarily packaged in a NaaS model, delivering LAN networking hardware and software, internet connectivity, and security as a consumption-based service through its cloud platform. The vendor's offering is designed for hands-off operation, targeting suitable organizations with limited resources. It is backed by an SLA.

The offering includes a plug-and-play approach for Day 1 network deployment, including integrations with digital conference rooms, managed printers and VoIP phones. Additionally, Join Digital's Workplace Analytics provides real-time data on occupancy, indoor environmental quality and network performance. However, opting for wired-only or wireless-only deployments with Join Digital may restrict the service, which is designed to be most effective with unified wired and wireless integration.

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Join Digital's strongest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to its NaaS offering that delivers operations for customers with limited I&O resources. Its weakest use-case score is in the wired-only refresh/new build use case, partly due to lack of campus fabric segmentation capabilities.

Juniper Networks

Juniper Networks' offering primarily includes Juniper APs and EX switches as part of a comprehensive wired and wireless LAN portfolio. Juniper Mist cloud management and cloud NAC capabilities excel at delivering optimized user and operator experiences.

Juniper Networks' offering has robust AI networking capabilities, which include Marvis VNA for AI-driven insights and troubleshooting, and Marvis Minis for proactive validation using a digital UX twin. In addition, this offering provides strong campus fabric capabilities that can ease campus and branch management of Juniper devices, by reducing network complexity and deployment inconsistencies. Full operations for the Juniper Mist solution are handled via the cloud. Limited switch and security capabilities are also available on-premises, but may not meet the needs of buyers requiring a full on-premises deployment.

Juniper Networks achieved the highest score in this research for both the WLAN-only refresh/new build and hands-off NetOps use cases, due to its advanced AI networking capabilities. Its score for the unified wired and wireless LAN use case is slightly compromised due to limited on-premises management options for wireless, which may impact buyers interested in on-premises-only offerings.

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Meter

Meter's offering is primarily packaged in a NaaS model, providing LAN networking hardware, software and security capabilities as a consumption-based service operated through its cloud platform.

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Meter's offering has strong AI networking and LAN infrastructure management capabilities, including Meter Command, all part of the NaaS offering. The NaaS service includes digital twin technology for Day 1 and Day 2 network operations, proactive alerting when issues and anomalies on the network arise, native configuration management database (CMDB) support, and quality monitoring of ISP connections. Additionally, Meter provides comprehensive features for guest services, which includes Citizens Broadband Radio Service (CBRS) cellular services that can be optionally included and natively managed. However, Meter lags in capabilities for advanced IoT onboarding and NAC services.

Meter's strongest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to its NaaS service and advanced AI networking and generative UI, Meter Command. The Meter offering was not rated for the wired-only and wireless-only refresh/new build use cases. This is because Meter does not recommend using its switches with third-party wireless APs and, conversely, Meter wireless infrastructure is not designed to support third-party switches.

Nile

Nile's offering is packaged and delivered as a NaaS, providing LAN networking hardware and security capabilities as a consumption-based service operated through its cloud platform.

Nile's control and management operate exclusively as a cloud platform, featuring strong campus fabric, management and AI networking capabilities. Additionally, Nile offers a robust guest access capability that independently routes guest traffic to a separate cloud application, ensuring guest traffic remains off the corporate network. All of this is backed by Nile's cloud operations, which automatically resolves issues and underpins its NaaS-offered SLA. However, Nile lacks a service or capability for customers to self-test configuration and validate changes.

Nile's strongest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to its NaaS capabilities and automated campus fabric deployment. The Nile offering was not rated for the wired-only and wireless-only refresh/new build use cases. This is because Nile's NaaS offering does not support third-party wireless APs and, conversely, its wireless infrastructure cannot connect to third-party switches.

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TP-Link

TP-Link's offering primarily includes the Omada and Omada Pro switches, wireless APs and management offerings. Omada Pro targets enterprise networks. The Omada Pro network management system can be deployed in the cloud (licensed) and on-premises (for free). The wireless portfolio includes Wi-Fi 7 APs.

TP-Link's wired and wireless LAN capabilities are positioned on a price-for-performance basis against other vendor hardware portfolios in the market. Additionally, Omada Pro offers feature parity, regardless of whether it is deployed on-premises or in the cloud. However, TP-Link lags other evaluated vendors in advanced network management and AI networking capabilities, with features that are basic. This impacted its scores for the unified wired, wireless LAN and hands-off NetOps use cases. Additionally, TP-Link's network security capabilities for zero-trust LAN and campus fabric are limited.

TP-Link's strongest use-case score is for the wired-only refresh/new build use case, due to its broad infrastructure portfolio noted for cost-effectiveness. Its weakest use-case score is for hands-off NetOps, due to limited AI networking capabilities.

TP-Link declined requests for supplemental information. Gartner's analysis is therefore based on other credible sources.

Context

This Critical Capabilities research is the companion to Gartner's Magic Quadrant for Enterprise Wired and Wireless LAN Infrastructure. It scores 16 offerings across four use cases designed to reflect the primary evaluation criteria that Gartner recommends for I&O leaders responsible for planning, procuring and managing enterprise wired and wireless access networks.

I&O leaders responsible for networking can use the critical capabilities assessed in this research to inform their search for appropriate offerings that more closely meet their specific use cases.

As enterprises navigate the complexities of modern networking, the wired and wireless LAN infrastructure market is increasingly defined by the pursuit of autonomous networks. This shift from hardware-centric decisions to software capabilities enables proactive management and optimization, driven by I&O leaders' priorities to minimize manual intervention, maximize uptime and ensure reliability.

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Unified LAN infrastructure management systems have evolved to offer sophisticated functionalities, yet there is a growing demand for simpler technologies that reduce training requirements while retaining advanced capabilities for complex networking tasks. The focus is shifting toward zero-trust principles, with the goal of unifying secure access across corporate sites, branch offices and hybrid work environments. Organizations are increasingly relying on all-wireless environments, facing challenges such as seamless onboarding, and improving in-building cellular connectivity for both known and unknown visitors. Additionally, there is a notable rise in opex buying models, including consumption models like network as a service (NaaS).

Market statistics:

Despite revenue growth in market segments like data center switching and SD-WAN, the overall enterprise network equipment market experienced a 3% decline in 2024, marking a significant shift from previous years (see Market Share Analysis: Enterprise Network Equipment, Worldwide, 2024). This downturn was primarily driven by a substantial decrease in enterprise wired and wireless LAN revenue:

- **Enterprise wired LAN:** Revenue fell by 22% in 2024, a stark contrast to the 20% growth seen in 2023, highlighting reduced demand and extended replacement cycles. Economic pressures and shifts in enterprise priorities have led organizations to delay upgrades and extend the life cycle of existing infrastructure.
- **Enterprise wireless LAN:** Market revenue declined by 12% in 2024, reversing the 12% growth seen in 2023, as macroeconomic factors led many organizations to prolong replacement cycles. In terms of 2024 AP shipments, Wi-Fi 6 (802.11ax) dominated with 72%, followed by Wi-Fi 6E at 8% and Wi-Fi 7 at 4%, reflecting the ongoing transition to newer wireless standards.

Key client questions:

- **Understanding trends:** What are the latest trends in the wired and wireless infrastructure market?
- **Vendor evaluation:** What key considerations should be made when evaluating technology vendors for campus networking to ensure informed decision making?
- **Emerging technologies:** How can AI, 5G and IoT be leveraged to improve business outcomes?

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- **Network security and compliance:** What strategies can be employed to ensure robust network security and compliance with industry standards?
- **Budgeting and cost optimization:** What are the best practices for budgeting and cost optimization in technology spending, and how can organizations negotiate better vendor agreements?

Market direction:

The enterprise campus LAN market is transforming with technological advancements and shifting client expectations. Organizations demand offerings that prioritize autonomy, campus networking software, and low-friction integration with existing IT infrastructures. As AI and AI networking continue to advance, networks will become increasingly self-sufficient, reducing the need for manual intervention and enhancing overall performance and reliability.

Vendor strategies:

Vendors are responding to these changes by developing AI-driven offerings, expanding flexible deployment options, and integrating advanced security models. By aligning their strategies with client demands, vendors can effectively address emerging challenges and capitalize on new opportunities in the evolving market landscape.

Market Definition

Gartner defines the enterprise wired and wireless LAN infrastructure market as the hardware and software that enables local connectivity for users and devices. The infrastructure components include enterprise-class wired switches and wireless access points, and the management software that secures, manages, tests, optimizes and automates the network.

Organizations across vertical markets rely on enterprise wired and wireless network infrastructures to connect and transmit data for both fixed and mobile devices, enabling end users to access applications that are located either on-site, in remote private or public destinations. In addition to end-user connectivity, these infrastructures offer capabilities for diverse market needs, including:

- Discovery, identification, security, management and segmentation of Internet of Things (IoT) and operational technology (OT) devices

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- Design and planning for network infrastructure requirements
- Implement zero-touch provisioning for deployment and configuration of the network infrastructure devices
- Offer support, testing and maintenance for network infrastructure components
- Establish a resilient infrastructure to withstand disruptions and provide continuous operations
- Implement robust security measures to safeguard the network infrastructure
- Scalability and flexibility for efficient management and control plane communication processes
- Provides a no-touch or low-touch environment for operations on Day 2

Mandatory Features

The mandatory features of this market include:

- Ethernet network switches suitable for deployment at the network access, distribution and core network layers
- IEEE 802.11 Wi-Fi-certified access points that support a combination of 2.4GHz, 5GHz and 6GHz radios
- Network management application provided in the vendor's cloud or available for local deployment on a physical or virtual appliance
- Network management application that securely connects to the infrastructure for administration
- Telemetry data generated by the wired and wireless infrastructure for optimization, troubleshooting and issue resolution
- Campus network fabric for user and device isolation, microsegmentation and application control
- Security application for user and device authentication and authorization
- Security application for creating and enforcing security policies

Common Features

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The common features for this market include:

Hardware capabilities:

- Wired switches equipped with Power over Ethernet (PoE) with standard PoE, PoE+, PoE++
- Wired switches equipped with multigigabit access ports up to 10 Gbps, and uplink ports up to 100 Gbps
- Wireless access points for indoor and outdoor environments, and optional external antennas
- Wireless access points equipped with single or dual Ethernet ports capable of multigigabit speeds
- Wireless access points that can support IoT devices that are physically connected (USB) or wirelessly connected (i.e., BLE)
- Wired and wireless hardware capable of MACSec support
- Wired and wireless hardware capable of campus fabric protocols (i.e., EVPN/VXLAN)

Management capabilities:

- Configuration of network infrastructure with automated zero-touch provisioning (ZTP)
- Network infrastructure configuration management: backup, restore and detection of configuration drift
- Performance monitoring and analytics for end users and applications they use on their devices
- Collection of telemetry data for AI- and ML-driven network assurance tools that troubleshoot and optimize the network
- Network AI assistants that provide natural language interfaces for configuration and troubleshooting tasks
- Application and behavior monitoring analytics, such as user and entity behavior analytics (UEBA), with the network security policy to facilitate appropriate action taking

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- Collection of locationing telemetry data from the infrastructure to provide indoor location services
- Capability to manage legacy third-party switches and access points through exported APIs, Simple Network Management Protocol (SNMP) and other methods
- Integration with IT service management (ITSM) applications, including ticketing systems

Network access control capabilities:

- Provides a mechanism for onboarding/offloading from public or private mobile networks (i.e., Passpoint, OpenRoaming)
- Provides a guest access portal that directs guests outside of the firewall for internet connectivity
- Provides onboarding and adaptive controls to apply zero-trust principles to all connected users and devices
- Provides the discovery, identification, security and management of nonuser devices (IoT/operational technology [OT])
- Provides a campus network fabric that establishes dedicated communication channels from the end-user connection to the intended destination. This fabric should seamlessly extend across third-party equipment (e.g., switches and access points) for microsegmentation capabilities.

Licensing models:

- Subscription- or perpetual-based licensing options for each component of the wired and wireless network infrastructure
- Consumption-based utility models that include the wired and wireless network infrastructure components, also known as network as a service (NaaS)

It is important to note that this research does not encompass wired and wireless networking infrastructure devices primarily utilized to support adjacent markets, such as point-to-point wireless WAN offerings, industrial/ruggedized LAN equipment or Wi-Fi hot spot services.

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Product/Service Trends

Gartner categorizes key emerging product trends in this market into two categories:

1. Growing integration of AI and GenAI capabilities into network management platforms. This is accelerating automation, allowing organizations to manage their network with fewer resources and reducing management costs. Software innovation, including the emergence of campus infrastructure and operations software (CIOS), is driving campus network modernization, including support for zero-trust LAN initiatives (see Market Guide for Campus Infrastructure and Operations Software).

2. While still a small part of the overall wired and wireless LAN infrastructure market, NaaS is emerging as an alternative model to traditional procurement and operational methods.

Areas of product/service enhancements include:

AI Networking and CIOS

- **AI/GenAI engines** — These transform data into insights, and insights into actions, such as orchestrated root cause analysis, guided troubleshooting and the ability to fix certain recurring issues without human intervention (see Quick Answer: What Is the Future of Enterprise Campus Networking?).
- **Day 0, Day 1 and Day 2 support** — To speed up network installations, incident response and repair times.
- **Integrations that enhance ITSM practices** — A lack of, or poor, integrations can lead to unapproved changes being pushed to production networks, whereas enhanced ITSM processes help with incident resolution and root cause analysis.
- **AI-driven, no-code network automation** — For scalability and to quickly remediate issues.
- **Network observability** — This includes customizable reports and dashboards, driven by intent-based verification. (For example, does the network architecture meet my application and security requirements?)

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- **Digital twin capabilities** — For protected change management (pre-, during and postvalidation of network changes), network snapshots (what changed and why?) and verification of changes before rollout. Includes the ability to verify that network changes are authorized and compliant.
- **Automated CVE vulnerability protection** — In addition to IT devices, this is critical for most IoT devices as they are often unpatchable or difficult to update, making it hard to address vulnerabilities identified by CVEs.
- **NAC capabilities** — Delivered as part of a campus fabric for automated onboarding and policy enforcement. Integration with patch management systems can deliver automated remediation when devices are missing critical patches.
- **Segmentation** — Including up to Layer 7.
- **Emerging universal ZTNA (uZTNA) capabilities** — uZTNA includes core NAC functionality as a feature. Adoption and buyer interest are predominantly driven by the need to secure employee connectivity (IoT/OT protection is still nascent as a use case).
- **NDR and UEBA functionality** — For in-depth application and network traffic monitoring, including the use of LLMs to explain anomaly patterns in encrypted or suspicious data.
- **Automated triaging capabilities** — To streamline the process of identifying and prioritizing critical and/or complex security incidents.

NaaS

- **Integration of more sophisticated AI, automation and security capabilities** — Delivered as part of the NaaS service.
- **Transparent SLAs and operational visibility** — For assurance that providers can meet the application requirements of organizations while delivering tight security controls.
- **Guest services that offer private 4G/5G connectivity** — These services provide an alternative to private DAS installations for customers and are billed based on consumption metrics.

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Critical Capabilities Definition

With the exception of “guest services” (added this year), the critical capabilities listed below are the same as in the 2024 iteration of this Research, albeit some of the wording has been updated for more accurate alignment with end-user market understanding and requirements. For example, “network security” has been updated to “zero-trust LAN.”

Wireless LAN

This capability evaluates the vendor’s enterprise WLAN solution, inclusive of WLAN access points, WLAN controllers/appliances, and integrated WLAN software/firmware.

Key functionality includes:

- Support for the latest wireless standards, including Wi-Fi 6E and/or Wi-Fi 7, with Wi-Fi Alliance certification to ensure interoperability with other certified devices.
- A range of wireless AP form factors that support different indoor and outdoor enterprise environments (including external connectors or antennas), with consideration for environmental durability.
- Robust authentication and authorization features, including support for WPA3 and built-in protections against unauthorized access.
- Ability to scale from hundreds to over 2,000 APs, ensuring the network retains active connectivity to the controller, whether on-premises, virtualized or cloud-based.
- WLAN management options, including both controller-based (on-premises appliance-based) and controllerless (cloud-managed or integrated in AP-based solutions) options.
- Support for application visibility and control tools/applications, enabling better network management and user experience.
- Ability to measure latency for voice and data applications and to provide sufficient data for mean opinion score (MOS) calculations to support toll-quality voice over WLAN (VoWLAN).
- IoT protocol support, enabling connection of IoT devices on wireless networks using different over-the-air protocols, such as BLE and ZigBee.

Point-to-point or point to multi-point (fixed wireless access/WAN) solutions are excluded.

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Wired LAN

This capability evaluates the vendor's wired LAN switching solution, including both hardware (fixed form factor and modular) and integrated software. Key components considered are performance, availability, scalability, interoperability and portfolio architecture.

Key functionality includes:

- Different form factors and port densities to meet specific wired switching requirements, including fixed-form-factor, port-extension and chassis-based switches.
- Product offerings for the core, distribution and access network layers.
- Support for network segmentation and integrated security mechanisms to enhance network security.
- Support for application visibility and control, enabling better network management and user experience.
- Multigigabit capabilities to enable 2.5/5/10 Gbps links to wireless APs, supporting high-density Wi-Fi 6, 6E or 7 deployments.
- Support for Power over Ethernet (PoE) and compliance with all relevant standards, ensuring the ability to power devices like IP phones, cameras and wireless access points (APs) directly through network cables.
- Energy-efficient features, such as support for Energy Efficient Ethernet (EEE), to reduce power consumption.
- Quality of service (QoS) capabilities to prioritize traffic for critical applications.
- Redundancy and failover mechanisms, such as link aggregation and Rapid Spanning Tree Protocol (RSTP).
- Support of standards-based protocols such as EVPN, VXLAN, IS-IS and SPB for campus fabric implementations.

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LAN Infrastructure Management

This capability evaluates the vendor's infrastructure management capability, encompassing the unified deployment (wired and wireless), configuration and ongoing management/administration across campus (HQ and/or main corporate sites), branch offices and remote locations.

This includes functionality embedded into individual network elements, the vendor's network management system, and integration with existing management tools (e.g., network performance monitoring and diagnostics [NPMD], and network configuration and change management [NCCM]) via standardized protocols or APIs. Additionally, it includes a migration capability for brownfield customers with older network equipment (vendor provided and multivendor).

Key functionality includes:

- A unified graphical configuration interface for network management, including mechanisms that reduce reliance on a legacy command-line interface (CLI) through APIs, scripting and templates across diverse environments.
- Day 1 deployment capabilities with automation tools such as zero-touch provisioning (ZTP).
- Day 2 troubleshooting capabilities for rapid issue identification and the ability to automatically identify and diagnose issues related to users and devices.
- Dynamic adjustment of resources and prioritization of critical users or applications in real time.
- Policy-based management, configuration and troubleshooting capabilities.
- System testing with digital twins, including CMDB integration and infrastructure component life cycle management.
- Multivendor network monitoring through Simple Network Management Protocol (SNMP) or APIs.
- Ability to update firmware and applications on all components, with variations for different network components.
- Integration with IT systems, such as ticketing and change control systems.

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Campus Fabric Segmentation

This capability evaluates the treatment of endpoints and the ability to effectively separate devices and applications by policy. It ensures network security through virtual segmentation, access control and IoT device containment.

“Fabric” technology approaches address the secure handling of all traffic, including IoT and OT, across the various layers of the network — from the access network connection (ingress point) to the final destination at the edge, data center or cloud.

Key functionality includes:

- Ability to deploy a wired and wireless campus fabric and implement policies that determine how users and devices access the network infrastructure.
- Ability to discover, identify, manage, secure and monitor all endpoints including IoT and OT.
- Ability to set a common policy for access across the wired and wireless fabric, ensuring consistent security and access control.
- Ability to identify the application and how it secures the device through virtual segmentation.
- Minimal support for wired and wireless underlay and overlay networks for microsegmentation, leveraging protocols such as VXLAN, BGP and SPB.

Zero-Trust LAN

This capability evaluates a zero-trust LAN, designed to protect network resources and attached devices governed by policy, including defining roles to control access levels/rights to network resources.

Zero-trust networking focuses on three main principles: verifying identity by ensuring every user and device is authenticated before accessing the network; restricting access by limiting entry to only the resources necessary for each user or device; and adjusting access dynamically by continuously updating permissions based on real-time risk assessments. This approach ensures secure access regardless of user or device location — whether at corporate sites or remote locations — and supports hybrid work environments that seek coffee-shop-style networks.

Key functionality includes:

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- Network access control (NAC) capabilities for end-user device profiling and authentication/onboarding, as well as for nonuser devices (IoT, OT). Minimal support must include 802.1X with TLS and TTLS.
- Network application or engine for policy and traffic enforcement at the network core, distribution and access layers (wired and wireless).
- Network enforcement policies that are based on authentication, endpoint configuration (posture) or users' role/identity.
- Anomaly detection, increasingly based on AI/ML capabilities, to identify suspicious activities on the network.
- User and identity behavioral analytics (UEBA) to monitor and analyze specific user- or policy-defined behavior patterns for security insights.
- Ability to apply zero-trust principles to all connected users and devices, with the capability to control application access.
- Support for, or integration with, security solutions such as UZTNA, firewalls, SSE or SASE, through first-party or third-party partnerships.

Guest Services

This capability evaluates the vendor's guest services functionality, focusing on onboarding and managing both known guests (employees with their own devices) and unknown guests (visitors) within a LAN network environment. This ensures seamless connectivity and enhanced UX for all guest users.

This capability facilitates guest access, authentication and connectivity, including the transition as guests roam from public cellular networks to in-building LAN networks.

Key functionality includes:

- Ability to onboard end-user guests to the campus wired and wireless network.
- Ability to provide robust guest authentication and onboarding solutions.
- Ability to onboard guests using captive portals and self-registration.
- Ability to automate guest onboarding to secure networks without user or IT intervention.

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- Ability to offer first-party or third-party solutions — such as neutral hosts, small cells or Distributed Antenna System (DAS) — to improve public cellular coverage in-building.

AI Networking

This capability evaluates the vendor's AI networking functionality to enhance network operations through advanced data collection and analysis.

By exposing infrastructure telemetry and leveraging comprehensive data collection, this capability employs AI/ML algorithms to train models, establish baselines, monitor and react to network conditions. It proactively resolves and reports LAN network connectivity issues. Vendor offerings range from requiring significant human intervention, such as manual configurations, to offering self-diagnosis and automated remediation with little or no human involvement, thereby optimizing network performance and reliability.

Key functionality includes:

- Proactive network controls that enhance performance optimization and issue resolution.
- AI and GenAI support (including via a network AI assistant with a natural language interface), to facilitate the management, troubleshooting and optimization of LAN networks.
- Unified telemetry with infrastructure components to ensure pertinent and consistent data collection and analysis.
- Root cause analysis, providing suggestions and remediation for network administrators to optimize WLAN settings, including non-radio resource management (RRM) issues.
- Detection, identification and remediation of wired issues, such as misconfiguration of VLANs and overloaded switches.
- Incident recognition in connectivity services, such as response times with the AAA server.
- Automation features, including provisioning and orchestration of network resources, automated network configuration with validation for consistency and compliance, and autoremediation based on identified anomalies.

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- Support of external APIs for third-party infrastructure components that may already exist within the customer environment.
- Automation with ITSM systems, such as ticketing and change control systems.

Use Cases

The following use cases are the same as in the 2024 iteration of this research, with the exception of "branch offices and SMBs," which has been removed.

Unified Wired and Wireless LAN

This is a company location or facility with more than 500 employees, requiring a secure network infrastructure that integrates both wired and wireless LAN components.

In this use case, campus fabric and zero-trust LAN capabilities are important, along with AI networking and LAN infrastructure management. The network supports end-user and IoT/OT connectivity, including guests and contractors. The buyer evaluates hardware platforms and operating system features to ensure functionality meets requirements, with particular focus on infrastructure telemetry and network policy enforcement. These capabilities collectively enhance network performance, improve security and simplify operations, making this use case ideal for environments where a unified approach to wired and wireless connectivity is essential.

This buyer is typically technically competent and relies on the I&O team to make granular changes to the wired and wireless LAN infrastructure components.

Wired-Only Refresh/New Build

This is a company location or facility with more than 500 employees, considering connectivity across the wired LAN, including the access, distribution and core.

While campus fabric and zero-trust LAN are evaluated, the primary focus is LAN infrastructure management capabilities. The buyer evaluates the hardware platforms and operating system features to ensure functionality meets requirements. This use case mostly applies to "brownfield" and refresh opportunities, often where an existing wired solution is in place providing connectivity for end users and IoT devices. Challenges like radio frequency interference and risk aversion may limit wireless LAN deployment, necessitating the need for a robust wired network.

This buyer is typically technically competent and relies on the I&O team to make granular changes to the wired LAN infrastructure components.

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WLAN-Only Refresh/New Build

This is a company location or facility with 500+ employees, where wireless is the main connection for end-user and IoT/OT connectivity, including guests and contractors.

This use case is often observed for “brownfield” and refresh opportunities. Users require pervasive mobility throughout the environment, both indoors and outdoors. While LAN infrastructure management and zero-trust LAN are evaluated, the primary focus is on AI networking and guest services capabilities. The buyer considers hardware platforms and operating system features like telemetry to enable AI networking, while also considering advanced wireless LAN features that support real-time communications such as voice and video.

This buyer is typically technically competent and relies on the I&O team to make granular changes to the wireless LAN infrastructure components.

Hands-Off NetOps

This is an emerging use case for organizations with over 500 employees that desire a software-first approach to their wired and wireless LAN networks.

While campus fabrics and guest services are part of the consideration, the buyer’s main focus is on AI networking, LAN infrastructure management and zero-trust LAN capabilities. The emphasis is on software, with hardware decisions being secondary and guided by the selected software, addressed later in the purchasing process. Essential features include AI-driven automation for problem resolution, robust security for LAN and IoT/OT environments, and a management interface that simplifies operations across multiple network vendors.

This buyer may have a limited or nonexistent I&O team and focuses on ensuring uptime and reliability, while reducing costs and manual intervention.

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Vendors Added and Dropped

Added

The following vendors were added to this iteration of the Critical Capabilities research:

- H3C
- Join Digital
- Meter
- Nile

Dropped

The following vendors did not fully meet this year's inclusion criteria and were therefore dropped from this iteration of the Critical Capabilities report:

- Cambium Networks did not satisfy Gartner's client relevancy or growth threshold criteria.

Inclusion Criteria

For Gartner clients, Magic Quadrant and Critical Capabilities research identifies and then analyzes the most relevant providers and their products in a market. Gartner uses by default an upper limit of 20 providers to support the identification of the most relevant providers in a market. On specific occasions, the upper limit may be extended by Methodologies where the intended research value to our clients might otherwise be diminished. The inclusion criteria represent the specific attributes that analysts believe are necessary for inclusion in this research.

To qualify for inclusion, each provider must:

- Demonstrate relevance to Gartner clients in the enterprise wired and wireless networking market by offering an Ethernet switching and wireless LAN (Wi-Fi) hardware and associated campus network application portfolio that addresses at least two of the three network layers (core, access and/or distribution) requirements as outlined in the Market Definition section.

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- Produce or OEM networking products, including access points, switches (mechanical and/or virtual stackable wired networking) and, optionally, appliances for on-premises applications for general availability as of 31 December 2024. All components must be publicly available for purchase, exist in inventory, and be available for shipping and included on the vendor's publicly published price list. Products shipping after this date will only have an influence on the Completeness of Vision axis.
- Meet the following revenue and growth threshold requirements:
  - Have customers in at least three of the following regions: APAC (including Japan), North America, Latin America and EMEA, with no more than 70% of annual revenue generated in any single region.
  - Have at least $200 million in annual revenue and at least 200 customers that use its enterprise wired and wireless LAN solution in the 12 months from 1 January 2024 to 31 December 2024, where "customer" is defined (per Gartner Methodologies) as a net-new installed logo that has paid for the equipment and/or is additionally paying (for subscription services) depending on the purchasing model.

Or

- Have at least $10 million in the 12 months from 1 January 2024 to 31 December 2024, and 50% growth compared with the previous 12 months.
- Have a cloud- and on-premises-capable platform that provides network discovery, identification, configuration, security, management, monitoring and integrated network automation tools.
- Offer campus network applications that offer, at a minimum, device and user segmentation, with specific remediation for guest users/devices and IoT devices.

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Table 1: Weighting for Critical Capabilities in Use Cases

Critical Capabilities	*Unified Wired and Wireless LAN*	*Wired-Only Refresh/New Build*	*WLAN-Only Refresh/New Build*	*Hands-Off NetOps*
Wireless LAN	20%	0%	40%	5%
Wired LAN	15%	40%	0%	5%
LAN Infrastructure Management	20%	20%	15%	35%
Campus Fabric Segmentation	10%	15%	0%	5%
Zero-Trust LAN	15%	15%	10%	5%
Guest Services	5%	0%	10%	5%
AI Networking	15%	10%	25%	40%
As of 2 June 2025				

Source: Gartner (June 2025)

This methodology requires analysts to identify the critical capabilities for a class of products/services. Each capability is then weighted in terms of its relative importance for specific product/service use cases.

Critical Capabilities Rating

Each of the products/services that meet our inclusion criteria has been evaluated on the critical capabilities on a scale from 1.0 to 5.0.

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Table 2: Product/Service Rating on Critical Capabilities

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Critical Capabilities	ALE	Allied Telesis	Arista Networks	Cisco (Catalyst)	Cisco (Meraki)	CommScope (RUCKUS)	Extreme Networks	Fortinet	H3C	HPE (Aruba)	Huawei	Join Digital	Juniper Networks	Meter	Nile	TP-Link
Wireless LAN	3.6	3.4	3.5	3.8	3.5	3.9	3.8	4.0	3.6	3.9	3.8	3.4	4.0	3.8	3.5	3.6
Wired LAN	4.0	3.9	4.3	3.8	3.3	3.8	3.9	3.6	4.0	3.9	3.9	3.2	4.0	3.5	3.5	3.7
LAN Infrastructure Management	3.2	2.4	3.6	3.4	3.4	3.1	3.4	3.3	3.2	3.7	3.7	4.0	3.7	4.5	4.2	2.0
Campus Fabric Segmentation	4.4	3.1	4.0	3.9	3.0	3.9	4.4	3.8	3.9	4.1	4.3	3.1	4.0	2.2	4.5	2.4
Zero-Trust LAN	3.0	2.7	3.9	3.9	3.1	3.1	3.7	4.3	3.4	4.3	4.2	2.6	3.5	2.3	2.8	2.5
Guest Services	3.7	3.3	3.6	3.9	3.8	3.9	3.9	3.2	3.6	4.0	3.9	2.9	4.0	3.7	3.3	2.4
AI Networking	2.9	2.5	3.6	3.4	3.2	2.8	3.4	3.3	3.1	3.1	3.8	3.4	3.9	3.5	3.4	2.3
As of 2 June 2025																

Source: Gartner (June 2025)

Table 3 shows the product/service scores for each use case. The scores, which are generated by multiplying the use-case weightings by the product/service ratings, summarize how well the critical capabilities are met for each use case.

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Table 3: Product Score in Use Cases

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Use Cases	ALE	Allied Telesis	Arista Networks	Cisco (Catalyst)	Cisco (Meraki)	CommScope (RUCKUS)	Extreme Networks	Fortinet	H3C	HPE (Aruba)	Huawei	Join Digital	Juniper Networks	Meter	Nile	TP-Link
Unified Wired and Wireless LAN	3.47	3.00	3.77	3.69	3.31	3.44	3.73	3.68	3.51	3.83	3.91	3.32	3.85	3.46	3.61	2.76
Wired-Only Refresh/New Build	3.64	3.16	3.99	3.71	3.24	3.47	3.80	3.65	3.65	3.87	3.96	3.28	3.86	N/A	N/A	2.85
WLAN-Only Refresh/New Build	3.32	2.95	3.59	3.66	3.40	3.43	3.64	3.67	3.40	3.72	3.84	3.36	3.88	N/A	N/A	2.81
Hands-Off NetOps	3.22	2.66	3.67	3.52	3.31	3.14	3.54	3.42	3.29	3.55	3.82	3.52	3.83	3.75	3.71	2.35
As of 2 June 2025																

Source: Gartner (June 2025)

To determine an overall score for each product/service in the use cases, multiply the ratings in Table 2 by the weightings shown in Table 1.

Evidence

To inform this research:

- Gartner analysts conducted approximately 1,500 discussions on the topic of wired and wireless LAN and associated technologies with clients/prospects in calendar year 2024 (i.e., client inquiry, conference 1:1).
- Most vendors in this research responded to a request for information (RFI) regarding current and planned capabilities, and a video submission following a script that highlights current product capabilities and future product roadmaps.
- Gartner analysts reviewed relevant reviews from Peer Insights.
- Gartner analysts reviewed publicly available information, including blogs, product specification sheets and financial information regarding vendors and products in this market.

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Critical Capabilities Methodology

This methodology requires analysts to identify the critical capabilities for a class of products or services. Each capability is then weighted in terms of its relative importance for specific product or service use cases. Next, products/services are rated in terms of how well they achieve each of the critical capabilities. A score that summarizes how well they meet the critical capabilities for each use case is then calculated for each product/service.

"Critical capabilities" are attributes that differentiate products/services in a class in terms of their quality and performance. Gartner recommends that users consider the set of critical capabilities as some of the most important criteria for acquisition decisions.

In defining the product/service category for evaluation, the analyst first identifies the leading uses for the products/services in this market. What needs are end-users looking to fulfill, when considering products/services in this market? Use cases should match common client deployment scenarios. These distinct client scenarios define the Use Cases.

The analyst then identifies the critical capabilities. These capabilities are generalized groups of features commonly required by this class of products/services. Each capability is assigned a level of importance in fulfilling that particular need; some sets of features are more important than others, depending on the use case being evaluated.

Each vendor's product or service is evaluated in terms of how well it delivers each capability, on a five-point scale. These ratings are displayed side-by-side for all vendors, allowing easy comparisons between the different sets of features.

Ratings and summary scores range from 1.0 to 5.0:

1 = Poor or Absent: most or all defined requirements for a capability are not achieved

2 = Fair: some requirements are not achieved

3 = Good: meets requirements

4 = Excellent: meets or exceeds some requirements

5 = Outstanding: significantly exceeds requirements

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To determine an overall score for each product in the use cases, the product ratings are multiplied by the weightings to come up with the product score in use cases.

The critical capabilities Gartner has selected do not represent all capabilities for any product; therefore, may not represent those most important for a specific use situation or business objective. Clients should use a critical capabilities analysis as one of several sources of input about a product before making a product/service decision.

Recommended by the Authors

Some documents may not be available as part of your current Gartner subscription.

Magic Quadrant for Enterprise Wired and Wireless LAN Infrastructure

How Products and Services Are Evaluated in Gartner Critical Capabilities

Toolkit: RFP for Wired and Wireless Enterprise Networks

Market Guide for Campus Infrastructure and Operations Software

Leverage Network Digital Twins to Increase Agility and Lower Risk

Best Practices for Cisco EA Negotiations

Quick Answer: What Must Be Included in I&O Pricing Proposals?

Best Practices to Optimize Network Spending

Market Guide for Enterprise Private Mobile Network Infrastructure

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Table 1: Weighting for Critical Capabilities in Use Cases

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Wired LAN	15%	40%	0%	5%
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Zero-Trust LAN	15%	15%	10%	5%
Guest Services	5%	0%	10%	5%
AI Networking	15%	10%	25%	40%
As of 2 June 2025				

Source: Gartner (June 2025)

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Table 2: Product/Service Rating on Critical Capabilities

Critical Capabilities	*ALE*	*Allied Telesis*	*Arista Networks*	*Cisco (Catalyst)*	*Cisco (Meraki)*	*CommScope (RUCKUS)*	*Extreme Networks*	*Fortinet*	*H3C*	*HPE (Aruba)*	*Huawei*	*Join Digital*	*Juniper Networks*	*Meter*	*Nile*	*TP-Link*
Wireless LAN	3.6	3.4	3.5	3.8	3.5	3.9	3.8	4.0	3.6	3.9	3.8	3.4	4.0	3.8	3.5	3.6
Wired LAN	4.0	3.9	4.3	3.8	3.3	3.8	3.9	3.6	4.0	3.9	3.9	3.2	4.0	3.5	3.5	3.7
LAN Infrastructure Management	3.2	2.4	3.6	3.4	3.4	3.1	3.4	3.3	3.2	3.7	3.7	4.0	3.7	4.5	4.2	2.0
Campus Fabric Segmentation	4.4	3.1	4.0	3.9	3.0	3.9	4.4	3.8	3.9	4.1	4.3	3.1	4.0	2.2	4.5	2.4
Zero-Trust LAN	3.0	2.7	3.9	3.9	3.1	3.1	3.7	4.3	3.4	4.3	4.2	2.6	3.5	2.3	2.8	2.5
Guest Services	3.7	3.3	3.6	3.9	3.8	3.9	3.9	3.2	3.6	4.0	3.9	2.9	4.0	3.7	3.3	2.4

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AI Networking	2.9	2.5	3.6	3.4	3.2	2.8	3.4	3.3	3.1	3.1	3.8	3.4	3.9	3.5	3.4	2.3
As of 2 June 2025																

Source: Gartner (June 2025)

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Table 3: Product Score in Use Cases

Use Cases	ALE	Allied Telesis	Arista Networks	Cisco (Catalyst)	Cisco (Meraki)	CommScope (RUCKUS)	Extreme Networks	Fortinet	H3C	HPE (Aruba)	Huawei	Join Digital	Juniper Networks	Meter	Nile	TP-Link
Unified Wired and Wireless LAN	3.47	3.00	3.77	3.69	3.31	3.44	3.73	3.68	3.51	3.83	3.91	3.32	3.85	3.46	3.61	2.76
Wired-Only Refresh/New Build	3.64	3.16	3.99	3.71	3.24	3.47	3.80	3.65	3.65	3.87	3.96	3.28	3.86	N/A	N/A	2.85
WLAN-Only Refresh/New Build	3.32	2.95	3.59	3.66	3.40	3.43	3.64	3.67	3.40	3.72	3.84	3.36	3.88	N/A	N/A	2.81
Hands-Off NetOps	3.22	2.66	3.67	3.52	3.31	3.14	3.54	3.42	3.29	3.55	3.82	3.52	3.83	3.75	3.71	2.35
As of 2 June 2025																

Source: Gartner (June 2025)

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